

Freeze the Reproduction Plan

Turn your assigned empirical study into a bounded, testable plan before major execution begins.

The point of this studio

This is the first project studio. Every group is working on a different assigned study. M1 is not a final result: it is a freeze of what you intend to reproduce, on what bounded material, using which method and decision rule, before the outcome can influence the plan.

1 · Start from your assigned study and project pack

Open the assigned paper/artefact and your project pack. Use the RQ(s) assigned to your group; do not replace them with easier questions or broaden the study. For each RQ, identify the exact source result you are trying to reproduce — for example the relevant section, table, figure, claim, metric or experiment in the original study.

Scope boundary

Use only the initial material released for your project. Do not inspect, analyse or consume held-out/Event material before it is released later in the module.

2 · Freeze the research question(s) and target result

In the M1 section of your Student Workbook, copy the assigned RQ(s) exactly and write one short target statement for each: what original result/relationship/comparison are you attempting to reproduce, and what output will your bounded reproduction produce?

Freeze item	What your group must record
RQ(s)	The exact RQ(s) from your project pack.
Source anchor	Where the corresponding original result/claim is located in the study or artefact.
Target result	The result, relationship, ordering, effect, count or other claim you are attempting to reproduce.
Out of scope	What you are deliberately NOT reproducing at M1.

3 · Bound the sample before you run

Define the exact material your first reproduction will use. A bounded sample must be small enough to complete and inspect, but precise enough that another group could identify the same material from your description.

Sample element	Freeze this now
Unit of analysis	What one case/item/commit/file/system/observation is for this study.
Source/version	Dataset, repository, release, artefact version or other source you will use.
Size/range	The exact bounded number/range of cases or observations.
Selection rule	Pre-declared selection rule, including exclusions and reasons.

4 · Freeze the method, metric and evidence route

Write the method at the level needed to execute and check it. Do not write only “follow the paper”. Your M1 plan should make the chain below clear.

INPUTS	PROCEDURE	OUTPUT / DECISION
What data/artefact/versio	The bounded procedure, tool/configuration and parameters that materially	What metric/result you will produce and how that output will be compared with the original claim.

n enters the reproduction and what preparation/filtering is required.	affect the result.	
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Record only parameters that matter to the result. If the source study does not specify something important, state the bounded decision your group will use rather than allowing it to change after you see the output.

5 • Pre-declare the expected result and decision rule

Before substantial execution, record what you expect if the original finding reproduces and define the rule you will use to interpret the result. The rule must match the type of claim in your assigned study; there is no single percentage tolerance that fits every project.

Outcome	Meaning
REPRODUCED	The completed bounded run satisfies your pre-declared criterion for the original claim/result.
NOT REPRODUCED	A valid completed run produces evidence that fails the pre-declared reproduction criterion.
INCONCLUSIVE / BLOCKED	The comparison cannot yet be interpreted because execution, data, environment or evidence is incomplete or invalid.

Important

A failed build, missing dependency or inaccessible dataset is not automatically “NOT REPRODUCED”. That is an execution/feasibility problem until you have a valid result to compare.

6 • Run a feasibility check — not the full study

Confirm that the released artefact/data can actually be accessed and that the first essential step of the method is executable. The purpose is to expose obvious blockers before M1 freezes, not to race ahead to the final reproduction result. Record any blocker with concrete evidence and what you tried.

7 • M1 coordinator checkpoint

Show the coordinator your Student Workbook and the source study/artefact. Be ready to point to the evidence rather than only describe it verbally.

Coordinator check	What must be visible
RQ + source	Exact assigned RQ(s) and a clear source anchor for the original target result.
Bounded sample	Exact unit, source/version, size/range, selection rule and exclusions.
Method	A concrete inputs → procedure → output/metric route that can be executed.
Expected result	Written before substantial execution and tied to the original study.
Decision rule	A defensible rule separating REPRODUCED, NOT REPRODUCED and INCONCLUSIVE/BLOCKED.
Feasibility	Evidence that the initial material is accessible and the first essential step can run, or a precise blocker is recorded.
Understanding	Your group can explain what is being reproduced, what is outside scope, and what evidence will answer the RQ(s).

M1 status is formative

The coordinator records a short evidence/understanding check in the central tracker. READY means the plan is clear enough to freeze. NOT YET means fix the missing evidence or ambiguity. BLOCKED means the plan is understood but a concrete feasibility problem still needs attention.

8 • Freeze M1, then begin the reproduction

Once the coordinator confirms M1 is READY, treat the recorded M1 plan as frozen and use the remaining studio work to begin the bounded reproduction. If you later discover that something genuinely must change, do not silently rewrite the original M1 entry. Record the deviation: what changed, why it changed, and how it affects interpretation of later evidence.

AI rule

GenAI may help you interpret, plan or troubleshoot, but it is not the source of the empirical method. Every important method choice, parameter and expected result must trace to the assigned study/artefact or to an explicit bounded decision recorded by your group.

M1 in one line

Freeze what you will test, on what material, how you will test it, what you expect, and what evidence would count as reproduction or non-reproduction — before the result can move those goalposts.